MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CLAM CHOWDER, MANHATTAN STYLE, SEMI-SOLID, TUBE PACK

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers tube packed semi-solid clam chowder, manhattan style for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44320 - Packaging and Processing of Foods in Collapsible Containers (Tubes)

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8935

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(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies may be obtained from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots

U.S. Standards for Grades of Sweet Peppers

U.S. Standards for Grades of Tomato Paste

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades (7 CFR Part 70)

(Copies may be obtained from the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, P.O. Box 96456, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies may be obtained from the Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agriculture Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0610, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

U.S. Standards of Identity for Canned Clams

(Copies may be obtained from the National Marine Fisheries Service, Office of Utilization Research, Washington, DC 20407.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199).

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCE

Food Chemicals Codex

(Copies should be obtained from the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

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(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.2).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.2 Clams, minced or chopped, canned. Canned clams shall be minced or chopped. The canned clams shall be packed in brine and shall comply with U.S. Standards of Identity for Canned Clams. The canned clams shall be of the latest date of pack.

3.2.3 Tomato paste. Tomato paste shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Tomato Paste.

3.2.4 Potatoes.

3.2.4.1 Potatoes, fresh. The potatoes shall be fresh, firm, and of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis.

3.2.4.2 Potatoes, frozen, diced. The frozen potatoes shall be firm, have a good color and flavor, and be of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis. The potatoes shall be of the most recent season's crop.

3.2.5 Broth, chicken. Chicken broth shall be frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The chicken broth shall be produced from USDA inspected fowl in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The broth shall be free from extraneous material or cracklings. If frozen, broth shall

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have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to use in product formulation. The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free (not more than 1 percent), and concentrated to a soluble solids level sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the product formulation. The broth shall have a characteristic mild-chicken broth odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA.

3.2.6 Celery, fresh. Celery shall be fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems, and damage.

3.2.7 Carrots.

3.2.7.1 Carrots, fresh. The carrots shall be fresh, firm, of good color, and of a variety suitable for canning.

3.2.7.2 Carrots, frozen. The frozen carrots shall comply with the U.S. Grade A requirements of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots and shall be of the most recent season's crop.

3.2.8 Bacon pieces, cooked. Cooked bacon pieces shall be a USDA inspected product produced from cured bacon with added smoke flavoring. The bacon pieces shall be free flowing and shall possess the color, odor, and flavor of properly cured and smoked bacon with no evidence of off-flavors and odors. The bacon pieces shall comply with the following analytical requirements: Moisture content - 38 percent (maximum); Fat content - 31 percent (maximum), and Salt content - 6.0 percent (maximum). The particle size shall be such that on a U.S. Standard Series Sieve, the following percentages (approximate) are retained:

U.S. Standard Series Sieve	Percentage retained (approximate)
0.265 inch	16.4
0.250 inch (US Standard 1/4)	29.0
0.187 inch (US Standard No. 4)	30.6
0.0937 inch (US Standard No. 8)	23.0

The bacon pieces shall be vacuum packaged in oxygen impermeable bags which have been backflushed with nitrogen. The packaging shall provide protection to the product from the effects of light. The packaged product shall be stored and shipped under refrigerated (30°F to 40°F) conditions. Time from manufacture to use of the bacon pieces shall not exceed 180 days.

3.2.9 Peppers, green, sweet, dehydrated. The peppers shall be 1/4 inch dices of sweet bell peppers which have been air-dried, freeze-dried or a combination of each. The pepper dices shall be practically free of seeds, seed cells, and diseased or rotted areas. The pepper dices shall possess a fresh, clean, typical sweet green pepper flavor and odor and a green, with minimal brownish, color. The moisture content shall be not greater than 5 percent.

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3.2.10 Peppers, green, sweet, fresh. Sweet green peppers shall be fresh, sound, firm and textured. The sweet green peppers shall be U.S. No. 1 of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Sweet Peppers.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with purity standards for sodium chloride as described in the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Lecithin, powder. Powdered lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.13 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner covering have been removed. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor, and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.14 Bay leaves, ground. Ground bay leaves shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. and shall possess a pleasant aromatic odor and a pungent mildly bitter flavor with a pale green to yellow-green color. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 1.0 mL per 100 grams of ground bay leaves. A minimum of 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.15 Allspice, ground. Ground allspice shall be derived from dried, nearly ripe fruit of Pimenta officinalis Lindl and shall possess a fragrant, clove-like aroma, a strongly aromatic, pungent, clove-like flavor, and a dark reddish-brown color. Allspice shall contain not less than 3.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground allspice with 80.0 percent eugenol as a principal constituent. A minimum of 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 25 sieve.

3.2.16 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formulation.

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3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Vegetable preparation.

3.3.1.1 Potato preparation.

3.3.1.1.1 Preparation of fresh potatoes. The fresh potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled and trimmed. The potatoes shall be chopped to a size which will accommodate the grinding operation. The chopped potatoes shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched potatoes shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained potato pieces shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and used in the product formulation within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.1.1.2 Preparation of frozen potatoes. Diced frozen potatoes shall be prepared in a manner to assure compliance with finished product requirements and shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration.

3.3.1.2 Carrot preparation.

3.3.1.2.1 Carrot preparation. The carrots shall be washed, sorted, peeled, and trimmed. The carrots shall be chopped to a size which will accommodate the grinding operation and then blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched carrot pieces shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained carrot pieces shall be handled in a manner to prevent spoilage and used in the product formulation within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.1.2.2 Preparation of frozen carrots. Frozen carrots shall be prepared in a manner to assure compliance with finished product requirements and shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration. The frozen carrots shall be chopped to a size which will accomodate the grinding operation.

3.3.1.3 Green pepper preparation.

3.3.1.3.1 Preparation of dehydrated green pepper dices. The dehydrated sweet green pepper dices shall be completely rehydrated and used in product formulation within 4 hours after rehydration.

3.3.1.3.2 Preparation of fresh green pepper dices. The fresh green peppers shall be washed, sorted, and trimmed. The peppers shall be chopped to a size which will accomodate the grinding operation and then blanched sufficiently to prevent spoilage and to remove excess air. The blanched pepper dices shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained pepper dices shall be handled in a manner to prevent spoilage and used in the product formulation within 4 hours after blanching.

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3.3.1.4 Celery preparation. The fresh celery shall be washed, sorted, and trimmed. The celery shall be chopped to a size which will accomodate the grinding operation and then blanched sufficiently to prevent spoilage and to remove excess air. The blanched celery dices shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent spoilage and used in the product formulation within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.2 Preparation of canned clams. The canned clams shall be thoroughly drained of brine solution and the drained clams shall be used in the product formulation within 2 hours after draining.

3.3.3 Product formulation. The formula for semi-solid manhattan style clam chowder for tube pack shall be as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by Weight
Water	47.91
Clams, canned, drained	17.00
Tomato paste 1/	10.10
Potatoes, fresh or frozen, chopped	9.20
Broth, chicken	5.00
Celery, fresh, chopped	4.20
Carrots, fresh or frozen, chopped	3.20
Bacon pieces, cooked	1.20
Peppers, green, sweet 2/	1.00
Salt 3/	0.90
Lecithin, powder	0.20
Pepper, white, ground	0.05
Bay leaves, ground	0.02
Allspice, ground	0.02

1/ The tomato paste shall be adjusted, as required, to produce a 26 percent tomato soluble solids level.

2/ When dehydrated green peppers are used they shall be rehydrated prior to inclusion in the product formulation.

3/ The total amount of salt in the chowder formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.4).

3.3.4 Product preparation.

a. The clams shall be ground twice through a grinder plate having holes measuring approximately 5/32 inch in diameter.

b. The vegetables and bacon shall be ground once through a grinder plate having holes measuring approximately 5/32 inch in diameter.

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c. Combine the balance of ingredients in one half of the formula water and mix thoroughly.

d. Add the ground ingredients and heat the mixture to 180° to 190°F while continuously stirring.

e. Add the balance of the formula water and mix thoroughly.

f. The product shall be maintained in the temperature range of 160° to 180°F and filled into the tubes within 2 hours after preparation.

3.3.5 Tube filling and sealing. Tubes shall be filled with 4.8 ounces of product as specified in MIL-P-44320. The filled tubes shall be immediately given a saddle-back fold and crimped securely, then sealed under vacuum by flushing the head space of each filled tube with super-heated steam. The filled and sealed tubes shall be thermoprocessed within 2 hours after sealing in accordance with MIL-P-44320.

3.4 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy, or sulfurous.

c. The product shall have a characteristic manhattan style clam chowder flavor.

d. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

e. The average net weight shall be not less than 4.8 ounces.

f. No individual tube shall have a net weight less than 4.6 ounces.

g. The salt content shall be not greater than 1.10 percent nor less than 0.50 percent.

h. The product shall not be rubbery.

i. The product shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

j. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

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3.4.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.2).

3.5 Plant qualifications. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods," and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

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4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to any identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, and filling requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed tube inspection. Inspection of filled and sealed tubes shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44320.

4.5.4 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed tubes shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty tube. Any individual net weight of less than 4.6 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in tubes. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tube. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, if the sample average net weight is less than 4.8 ounces, it is a major defect and the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.5 Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample tubes shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the retort process. The tubes shall be opened and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in tubes. The sample unit shall be the contents of one tube. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Product is rubbery
102	Product is not smooth
103	Product is excessively thick or thin
104	Product is lumpy
105	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)
106	Product does not have a characteristic manhattan style clam chowder flavor

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, paint, paper, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy, or sulphurous), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

4.5.6 Salt content testing. The sample tubes shall be opened and the entire contents of each tube shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The salt content of the product from each tube in the sample shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 percent. Any result failing to conform to the salt requirement in 3.4 shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in tubes. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tube. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

4.5.7 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44320.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-P-44320.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Clam chowder
Manhattan style
Semi-Solid
Tube

Custodians:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, SA
Air Force - 50
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8935-A089

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44350(GL)	Clam Chowder, Manhattan Style, Semi-Solid, Tube Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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